Examine Your Impressions

Is it true, or does it just feel true?

READING · ONE LINE, THEN AN EXERCISE

Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 1 (the last lines): meet every harsh impression by reminding yourself it is only an impression, not necessarily what it appears to be. Then test it. See the wiki's Examine Your Impressions.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Ask members to bring one recent moment when a first reaction turned out to be wrong.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Practice · 20	Discuss · 40	Close · 10
Ground rules; welcome newcomers	Aloud, together	Test one impression together	The questions below	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What impression hit you hardest this week? What was it asking you to believe?
2. When you got it wrong, was the error in the facts, the value you placed on something, or the action you took?
3. Which impressions win you over fastest: fear, pleasure, urgency, or authority?
4. Epictetus pictures a night watchman asking each impression to show its pass. What would your pass check?
5. What short question could you ask yourself in the moment?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Show me your pass. Before acting on a strong reaction, ask: What am I being asked to believe? What supports it? What can I endorse?

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"How would you know?" It's the heart of this exercise. Use it on the group's examples.

NOTES